As a future cybersecurity professional, my biggest ethical dilemmas will include responsible research, potential whistleblowing, and balancing user privacy and security. Responsible research is crucial in cybersecurity because many professionals have access to loads of sensitive data from organizations or users. Some have access to powerful tools available only to high-ranking authorizers or to confidential systems. For example, you can test a system's security by hacking it, but without authorization, even a single step can raise ethical and legal issues. What does potential whistleblowing mean in an organization?

If I spot unethical use of information being spread, should I report it? Speaking out against unethical means would protect the public and maintain professional integrity, but it could also risk your career and reputation. Lastly, balancing user privacy and security requires setting a boundary between the two. Professionals must be able to decide how much information to collect or monitor without risking violations of users' rights. These three ethical dilemmas require not just basic technical knowledge but also a strong background in the ACM and IEEE codes of ethics.

To prepare for these ethical challenges, one should develop a strong background in understanding the code of ethics. It's also essential to create a strong sense of professional integrity, making it easier to integrate the code of ethics. In cybersecurity, rash decisions are made daily, and there are plenty of times when the right choice is not the obvious one. I plan to prepare by studying the old code of ethics, as well as the new ones. Another method could be to examine how professionals handle major data breaches or whistleblowing incidents to better understand how those situations are handled.

While staying in line with the current code of ethics, I can make better-informed decisions regarding legal and professional values. Another method could be immersing myself in

the company of other professional mentors or colleagues who prioritize ethics. The ACM and IEEE Codes of Ethics prioritize honesty, privacy, and integrity, and can serve as guides for anyone pursuing the field. I know there's much to learn about the code of ethics and what applies and doesn't, but maintaining these principles will help me meet the challenges ahead responsibly.

One principle from the IEEE Code of Ethics is “to seek, accept, and offer honest criticism of technical work, to acknowledge and correct errors, to be honest and realistic in stating claims or estimates based on available data, and to credit properly the contributions of others.” This principle promotes honesty, accountability, and modesty, all of which are essential in the cybersecurity field. Professionals must be able to accept constructive criticism and recognize that minor errors pose a significant risk to the task at hand. This idea is reflected in the Bible, emphasizing the need to be truthful and the desire to learn from errors.

Ephesians 4:29 (CSB) says, “No foul language should come from your mouth, but only what is good for building up someone in need, so that it gives grace to those who hear.” This verse encourages positive, honest feedback rather than completely breaking down the other person. At the same time, Colossians 3:23 (CSB) says, “Whatever you do, do it from the heart, as something done for the Lord and not for people.” This verse encourages you to work with integrity, knowing that your work will reflect your faith and ultimately your character. These verses together support the IEEE principles of honesty, accountability, and modesty, demonstrating that they apply not only in the workplace but also in everyday life.

One principle from the ACM Code of Ethics is “1.6 Respect privacy.” This principle highlights the importance of protecting the personal and confidential information that organizations or individuals may give to professionals. In cybersecurity, you have to be extremely careful when handling user or organizational data. This is because the slightest

mistake can be costly or expose sensitive client information. Cybersecurity professionals are placed in a position of great trust, so every action must be taken ethically. Mishandling or even misusing information not only violates a person's rights but also damages your credibility and professional ethics.

The principle of privacy is more than just a company rule; it's a guideline for protecting people's information and organizational security. The bible reflects this principle while emphasizing the need to respect others' privacy and uphold trust. Proverbs 11:13 (CSB) says, “A gossip goes around revealing a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence.” This verse tells us that keeping information private is not just about following policy, but also about being a trustworthy person.

In the cybersecurity field, professionals must exercise a high level of discretion, as even the slightest decision could alter or expose highly sensitive user data. At the same time, Proverbs 20:19 says, “"The one who reveals secrets is a constant gossip; avoid someone with a big mouth.” This verse highlights the importance of not sharing information that is not your own. It also says how much damage can be caused by a single utterance of gossip. In the digital world, it's essential to prevent behaviors that could lead to unethical decisions while maintaining an ethical, responsible workplace.

In conclusion, professional ethics are essential for making ethical decisions and maintaining integrity in the cybersecurity field. Whatever the task, responsible research, whistleblowing, or respecting privacy, it will still require you to act with honesty and accountability. The ACM and IEEE Code of Ethics provide strong guidelines to follow when dealing with these issues, while encouraging you to adopt these traits. In terms of Biblical values,

the principles also align with the idea that it's not just a matter of professional courtesy to follow them, but that they can also reflect your character.

Works Cited

ACM. “The Code Affirms an Obligation of Computing Professionals to Use Their Skills for the Benefit of Society.” Code of Ethics, www.acm.org/code-of-ethics. Accessed 7 Nov. 2025.

GOD. “Read the Bible Online. A Free Bible on Your Phone, Tablet, or Computer.: The Bible App.” YouVersion | The Bible App | Bible.Com, www.bible.com/. Accessed 7 Nov. 2025.

IEEE. “IEEE Code of Ethics | IEEE.” IEEE Code of Ethics, www.ieee.org/about/corporate/governance/p7-8. Accessed 8 Nov. 2025.